

Form H31

(December 2024)



The **ACT**[®]

2024 | 2025

In response to your request for Test Information Release materials, this booklet contains the test questions, scoring keys, and conversion tables used in determining your ACT scores. Enclosed with this booklet is a report that lists each of your answers, shows whether your answer was correct, and, if your answer was not correct, gives the correct answer.

ACT owns the test questions and responses, and you may not share them with anyone in any form.



ENGLISH TEST

35 Minutes—50 Questions

DIRECTIONS: In the passages that follow, certain words and phrases are underlined and numbered. In the right-hand column, you will find alternatives for the underlined part. You are to choose the best answer to each question. If you think the original version is best, choose “No Change.”

You will also find questions about a section of the passage, or about the passage as a whole. These questions do not refer to an underlined portion of the passage, but rather are identified by a number or numbers in a box.

For each question, choose the alternative you consider best and fill in the corresponding oval on your answer document. Read each passage through once before you begin to answer the questions that accompany it. For many of the questions, you must read several sentences beyond the question to determine the answer. Be sure that you have read far enough ahead each time you choose an alternative.

PASSAGE I

Havana’s Camerata Romeu

[1]

As the rhythmic sounds of “Camerata en Guaguancó” ring out in the historic Havana basilica, the visibly thrilled audience listens with rapt attention. [A] It’s December, and Camerata Romeu, an all-woman string chamber orchestra, now performing its annual holiday concert for the

1

city’s thrilled classical music fans.

2

[2]

As a young conductor, Zenaida Romeu wanted to showcase the talent of Cuba’s female musicians as well as that of Cuban and Latin American classical composers. [B] So in 1993, despite the skepticism of critics devoted exclusively to the European classical canon, she founded Camerata Romeu.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

1. A. NO CHANGE
- B. that is
- C. is
- D. DELETE the underlined portion.

Which choice is least redundant in context?

2. F. NO CHANGE
- G. city’s classical music fans, who have assembled in the basilica to hear the orchestra.
- H. city of Havana’s classical music fans in the basilica.
- J. city’s classical music fans.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.



[3]

Romeu hoped to bridge the gap she saw
between classical music and young audiences. Because
she wanted her musicians to maintain their identities as
young people themselves, she decided that they would

dress less formally than typical orchestra members.
Furthermore, they would play all of their pieces from

memory. Forgoing music stands—Romeu believed,

would rectify the emotional expressiveness of the music
and foster a more immediate connection with audience
members of all ages. These approaches worked;

audiences went to the group's performances.

[4]

Regardless, Camerata Romeu is made up mainly
of women who join the ensemble while attending the
prestigious music school at Havana's Higher Institute

of Art. A spot in Romeu's orchestra is coveted among
musicians, who must pass a highly selective audition
process. [C] Playing complex pieces from memory

3. Given that all the choices are accurate, which one best introduces the main focus of the paragraph?

A. NO CHANGE
B. was the first woman in Cuba to graduate with an advanced degree in orchestra conducting.
C. knew that classical music was not a genre most people associated with Cuba.
D. was committed to bringing each composer's vision for a given piece to fruition.

Which choice most effectively maintains the essay's tone?

4. F. NO CHANGE
G. not be as uptight about what they wore, unlike
H. dress down a bit, honestly, compared to
J. forget about dressing up as fancily as

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

5. A. NO CHANGE
B. stands, Romeu
C. stands Romeu,
D. stands Romeu

Which choice is clearest and most precise in context?

6. F. NO CHANGE
G. enhance
H. inflate
J. revise

7. Which of the following choices most precisely expresses the idea that audiences were enthusiastic about attending Camerata Romeu's performances?

A. NO CHANGE
B. assembled at
C. turned up at
D. flocked to

Which transition word or phrase, if any, is most logical in context?

8. F. NO CHANGE
G. For example,
H. In contrast,
J. DELETE the underlined portion.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

9. A. NO CHANGE
B. whom
C. which
D. that

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.

1



1

absolutely require an extraordinary amount of work
10

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

10. F. NO CHANGE
G. have always required
H. requires
J. require

and dedication. In return, as Romeu mentors
11

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

11. A. NO CHANGE
B. In return,
C. While
D. As

toward these budding professionals. [D]
12

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

12. F. NO CHANGE
G. with
H. at
J. DELETE the underlined portion.

[5]

Over the years, Camerata Romeu has become a cultural institution in Cuba, featuring music created by prominent Latin American composers especially for the orchestra. When it isn't playing at home, the group can be found sharing its special brand of Latin classical music internationally. But the time the orchestra spends, in Havana, culminates in this annual concert,
13

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

13. A. NO CHANGE
B. spends in Havana
C. spends in Havana,
D. spends, in Havana

an opportunity for musicians and fans to connect.
14

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

14. F. NO CHANGE
G. this is a great
H. it's an
J. DELETE the underlined portion.

Question 15 asks about the preceding passage as a whole.

15. The writer wants to add the following sentence to the essay:

But the challenge doesn't end there.

The sentence would most logically be placed at:

- A. Point A in Paragraph 1.
B. Point B in Paragraph 2.
C. Point C in Paragraph 4.
D. Point D in Paragraph 4.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.



PASSAGE II

Nest in the Sand

Driving slowly along an empty beach on Kiawah Island, South Carolina, I notice an area of scattered sand among the dunes: a sign of a potential sea turtle nesting site. As a volunteer conservationist working to protect endangered loggerhead sea turtles, I patrol the beach before sunrise, scanning for evidence of any nests created overnight. It rained yesterday, so any marks I see this morning were surely made last night.

The area of disturbed sand is practically forty yards¹⁶ from the water's edge. It's not uncommon for a female loggerhead, weighing up to three hundred pounds, to

make a slow and exhausting crawl this far onto the beach¹⁷ to find a safe nesting spot. Once she selects a site, the

turtle uses her flippers to dig a large pit, she lays a clutch¹⁸ of nearly one hundred eggs. To conceal the site, she

throws sand all around the area. 19

16. Which choice makes most clear that the narrator thinks the area of disturbed sand may be more than forty yards from the water's edge?

F. NO CHANGE
G. close to
H. at least
J. nearly

17. The writer is considering deleting the underlined portion. Should the underlined portion be kept or deleted?
- A. Kept, because it indicates the length of time it generally takes for a sea turtle to pick a nesting spot.
B. Kept, because it helps emphasize how arduous the journey to find a nesting spot is for a sea turtle.
C. Deleted, because it detracts from the paragraph's focus on the process a sea turtle uses to find a nesting spot.
D. Deleted, because it implies that some sea turtles choose their nesting spots close to the water's edge.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

18. F. NO CHANGE
G. pit into which she
H. pit, which she
J. pit,

19. Given that all the following choices are accurate, which one, if added here, would best conclude the paragraph by indicating the final actions taken by the nesting sea turtle?
- A. It may look as though she's crying, but her "tears" are flushing away excess seawater and sand.
B. Female loggerhead turtles typically nest on the island between May and October each year.
C. She then trudges back to sea, never to return to the nest.
D. Later on, the eggs will hatch.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.

1



1

I approach the area on foot, cautiously. Though the extent of sand thrown about are characteristics of a turtle's dig site, I can't be sure I've found a nest yet. Sometimes

sea turtles create what's called: a "false crawl." For one reason or another, a loggerhead may plod onto the

beach 22 without laying eggs. This site is promising,

equally, because of something I notice about the tracks

that mark the turtle's approach and their withdrawal. The tracks leading to the site are marked by deep,

comma-shaped divots in the sand, evidence of the turtle hoisting her belly up so as not to drag her eggs on the ground. The return tracks, in other words, reveal that the turtle dragged herself back to sea. The shallow path

in the sand that was made smooth by her prostrate belly, is a clear sign she's left eggs behind.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

20. F. NO CHANGE
G. are characteristic
H. is characteristics
J. is characteristic

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

21. A. NO CHANGE
B. what is called,
C. what's called,
D. what's called

22. If the writer were to add the phrase "and even dig a hole" at this point, the paragraph would primarily gain:
F. information about how the indications of a loggerhead nesting site can be misleading.
G. a detail that helps emphasize how rare it is for the narrator to locate a loggerhead nest.
H. a reminder that the narrator has spotted a nest but has yet to locate the mother turtle.
J. an indication of why loggerheads dig holes for purposes other than nesting.

Which transition word or phrase is most logical in context?

23. A. NO CHANGE
B. unfortunately,
C. furthermore,
D. though,

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

24. F. NO CHANGE
G. this
H. it's
J. DELETE the underlined portion.

Which transition word or phrase is most logical in context?

25. A. NO CHANGE
B. consequently,
C. in contrast,
D. therefore,

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

26. F. NO CHANGE
G. sand that,
H. sand,
J. sand

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.

1



1

[1] If left undisturbed, the turtles will begin to hatch
 in two months. [2] Having found the well-hidden nest, I

record it's location, the first step in keeping the eggs safe.

[3] They'll emerge from underground as a group and

follow the light of the moon to the sea. 29

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

27. A. NO CHANGE
 B. turtle's will begin to hatch
 C. turtles will begin to hatch,
 D. turtles' will begin to hatch,

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

28. F. NO CHANGE
 G. where its' located,
 H. where its located,
 J. its location,

29. Which sequence of sentences makes this paragraph most logical?

- A. NO CHANGE
 B. 2, 1, 3
 C. 2, 3, 1
 D. 3, 2, 1

Question 30 asks about the preceding passage as a whole.

30. Suppose the writer's primary purpose had been to portray someone working to protect an endangered species. Would this essay accomplish that purpose?

- F. Yes, because it clarifies how to distinguish between the tracks and nests of endangered loggerhead turtles and those of other sea turtles.
 G. Yes, because it provides a firsthand account of a volunteer's efforts to locate the nests of endangered loggerhead turtles.
 H. No, because it primarily focuses on explaining the positive impact of efforts to protect loggerhead turtle nests.
 J. No, because it primarily focuses on describing the reasons loggerhead sea turtles are endangered.

PASSAGE III

A Cut Above the Rest

In the first half of the nineteenth century, as silhouette
 portraits grew popular in the United States. With just paper
 and scissors, a skilled silhouettist could craft a convincing

outline of a person in minutes. Although the art could be
 produced quickly with simple materials, it cost little. A
 large portion of the populace could afford silhouettes of
 themselves or of loved ones.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

31. A. NO CHANGE
 B. The first half of the nineteenth century, in which
 C. When, in the first half of the nineteenth century,
 D. In the first half of the nineteenth century,

Which choice is clearest and most precise in context?

32. F. NO CHANGE
 G. Because
 H. While
 J. As if

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.



Perhaps the most remarkable silhouettist of the era was William Henry Brown, born in South Carolina in 1808. As a teenager, Brown displayed an impressive³³

ability to produce silhouettes, as he put it,³⁴ “with wonderful facility and accuracy.” He turned his

talent into a career. 35 A key feature of Brown’s

silhouettes were³⁶ that instead of depicting only a

subject’s head and torso,³⁷ the usual style—Brown cut full-length portraits. Unlike the static profiles seen in most silhouettes, Brown’s figures stood, sat, walked, and rode horses. In particular, his 1846 book, *Portrait Gallery of Distinguished American Citizens*, displayed the potential of the full-length format. An astute observer, Brown captured each subject’s character through details³⁸

33. Which choice most clearly emphasizes that Brown’s talent came naturally to him?
- A. NO CHANGE
 - B. an instinctive
 - C. an unusual
 - D. a refined

34. Which of the following alternatives to the underlined portion would NOT be acceptable?
- F. he could make them, he said,
 - G. claiming he could make them
 - H. making them, in his words,
 - J. he claimed,

35. At this point, the writer is considering dividing the paragraph into two. Should the writer begin or not begin a new paragraph here?
- A. Begin a new paragraph, because the essay shifts here from an outline of Brown’s early career to an evaluation of how the style of his silhouettes evolved over the course of his career.
 - B. Begin a new paragraph, because the essay shifts here from information about Brown’s life and the start of his vocation to a consideration of the characteristics of his silhouettes.
 - C. DO NOT begin a new paragraph, because doing so would interrupt the discussion of the ways Brown’s upbringing influenced the subject matter he chose for his silhouettes.
 - D. DO NOT begin a new paragraph, because doing so would interrupt the account of how Brown learned the art of making silhouettes.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

36. F. NO CHANGE
- G. have been
 - H. was
 - J. are

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

37. A. NO CHANGE
- B. head and torso—
 - C. head, and torso,
 - D. head, and torso

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

38. F. NO CHANGE
- G. Brown’s style captured the character of each subject
 - H. the silhouettes captured each subject’s character
 - J. each subject’s character was captured

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.



of posture, dress, gesture, and movement.

Brown didn't limit himself to depicting lone individuals either. His twenty-five-foot-long portrayal of the St. Louis Fire Company, including a fire engine

39

and sixty-five men. Additionally, Brown supplemented some of his silhouettes with paint and ink, such as in *Hauling the Whole Week's Picking*, which showed nine people, four mules, three dogs, two oxen, and two wagons

containing cotton. The paint, in a range of brown and

41

yellow tones, bring a breath of immediacy into the scene, as if the workers have just left the field.

42

In the 1850s, photography became inexpensive, and demand for silhouettes nearly disappeared. Fortunately, Brown found work as a train engineer, a profession he had trained for as a youth. Even more, fortunately he had

43

already created a body of work, his silhouettes represent the pinnacle of the art.

44

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

39. A. NO CHANGE
B. Company, which includes
C. Company that included
D. Company included

Which choice is least redundant in context?

40. F. NO CHANGE
G. as in *Hauling the Whole Week's Picking*, Brown supplemented
H. with paint and ink, Brown supplemented
J. Brown supplemented, furthermore,

41. Which choice most clearly conveys that the wagons carried substantial loads of cotton?

- A. NO CHANGE
B. with cargos of
C. burdened with
D. conveying

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

42. F. NO CHANGE
G. introduce a breath of
H. breathes
J. breathe

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

43. A. NO CHANGE
B. Even, more fortunately,
C. Even, more fortunately
D. Even more fortunately,

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

44. F. NO CHANGE
G. work, such is a representation of
H. work, these images represent
J. work that represents

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.

Question 45 asks about the preceding passage as a whole.

45. Suppose the writer's primary purpose had been to detail the history of a particular art form. Would this essay accomplish that purpose?
- A. Yes, because it describes the era in which silhouette-making was most popular and some of the most famous silhouettes that were produced at the time.
 - B. Yes, because it follows the history of silhouette-making from its invention to its decline.
 - C. No, because while it provides some historical information about silhouette-making, it mainly focuses on the work of one exceptional silhouettist.
 - D. No, because while it describes some important historical silhouettes, it mainly focuses on the process of creating silhouettes.

PASSAGE IV

Swimming with the Sharks

[1] Instead of recognizing sharks as complex creatures worthy of respect and study, people largely considered them primitive brutes. [2] Before the 1950s, misinformation about sharks were pervasive.

46

[3] Dr. Eugenie Clark, a pioneer in marine science, dedicated her career to changing this widespread misperception of the animals. [47]

Clark's fascination with sharks was ignited in childhood; during weekly visits to the New York Aquarium, she spent hours watching the animals.

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

46. F. NO CHANGE
 G. toward sharks was
 H. about sharks was
 J. on sharks were
47. Which sequence of sentences makes this paragraph most logical?
- A. NO CHANGE
 - B. 2, 1, 3
 - C. 2, 3, 1
 - D. 3, 2, 1

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE.



Of Japanese heritage, Clark credited her interest in studying marine biology to a key facet of Japanese culture, earning her doctorate in 1950. A passionate and

inquisitive researcher, Clark once founded the Cape Haze Marine Laboratory in Florida. There, her research on sharks led to groundbreaking discoveries.

In 1958, for instance, Clark helmed an experiment in which two lemon sharks were trained to press an underwater target to obtain food. She later expanded the study, teaching sharks to visually distinguish between targets of varying shapes and colors.

48. The writer is considering revising the underlined portion to the following:

the sea's importance in

Given that the information creates a sentence that is still accurate, should the writer make this revision?

- F. Yes, because the revision helps clarify the connection between Clark's interest in marine biology and her Japanese heritage.
- G. Yes, because the revision explains why the sea plays an important role in Japanese culture.
- H. No, because the revision detracts from the discussion of Clark's interest in marine biology.
- J. No, because the revision conflicts with the essay's indication that Clark was interested in the sea since childhood.

49. Which choice most clearly indicates that Clark founded the laboratory shortly after earning her doctorate?

- A. NO CHANGE
- B. eventually
- C. recently
- D. soon

Which choice makes the sentence most grammatically acceptable?

50. F. NO CHANGE
 G. this time, she taught
 H. she was teaching
 J. she taught

END OF TEST 1

STOP! DO NOT TURN THE PAGE UNTIL TOLD TO DO SO.